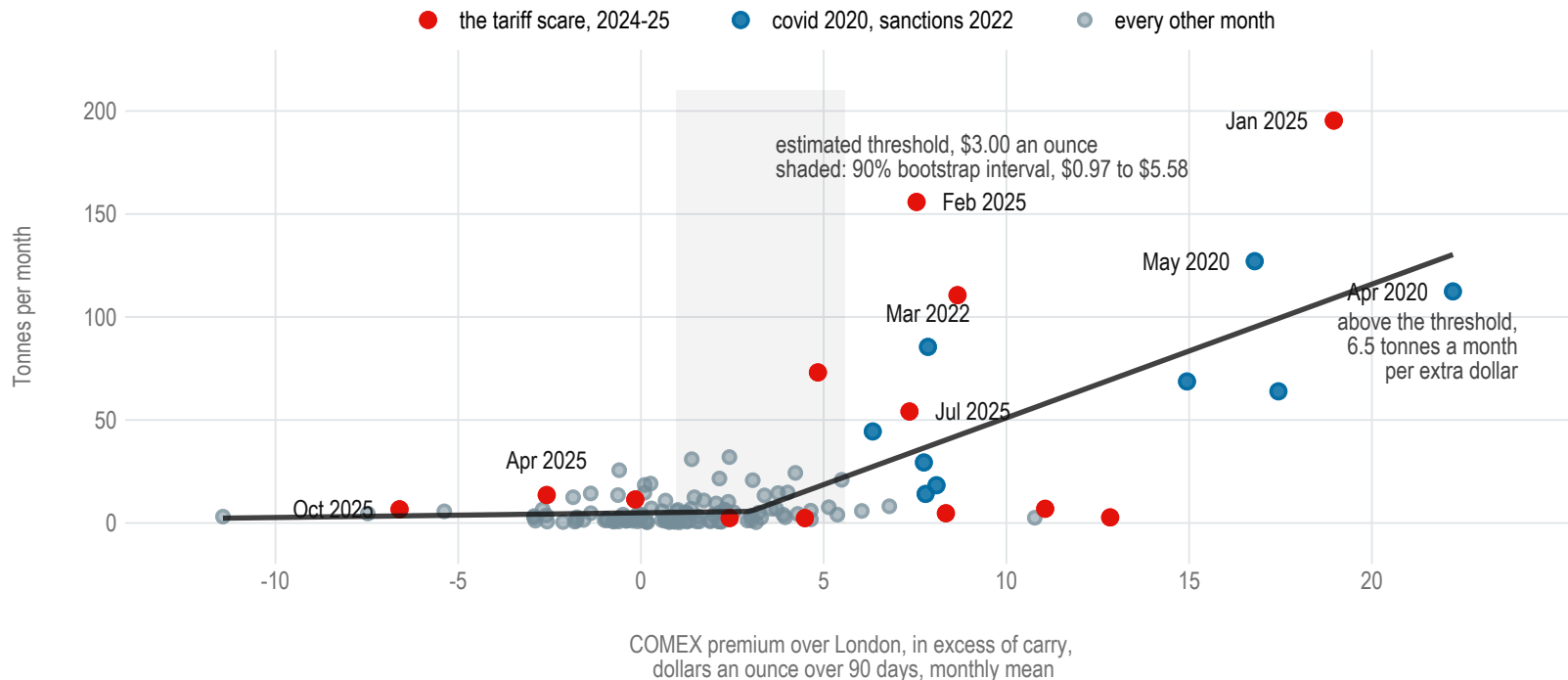


Nothing moves until the premium clears the cost of moving

Swiss customs gold exports to the United States against the New York premium. Each dot is one month, January 2015 to July 2026



The threshold is estimated, not drawn. A continuous kink - tonnes = $a + b_1(x-g) + b_2 \max(0, x-g)$ - with g chosen by profile least squares over a grid, 15% of the sample trimmed from each regime, and a 90% interval from 2,000 iid and moving-block bootstrap replications. The slope below the threshold is 0.2 tonnes per dollar, indistinguishable from flat; above it, 6.5. R-squared 0.53 against 0.43 for a straight line. Dropping the three largest months moves g to \$2.69; fitting on 2015-2023 alone, with the whole tariff episode excluded, moves it to \$3.58 - so the episode is not what identifies it. In logs no interior kink is identified; the hinge is a claim about quantities, and logs compress the months that make it.

Sources: Swiss Federal Customs Administration; CME; LBMA; FRED